



COUNTY GOVERNMENT OF GARISSA

PARTNERSHIPS AND COORDINATION POLICY

AUGUST, 2025





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ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

ADPs	Annual Development Plans
(CAIS)	County Aid Information System
CBOs	Community-Based Organizations
CAIS	County Aid Information System
CBROP	County Budget Review and Outlook Papers
CEC	County Executive Committee
CECM	County Executive Committee Member
CEF	County Engagement Forum
CFSP	County Fiscal Strategy Paper
CG	County Government
CIDP	County Integrated Development Plan
CPSB	County Public Service Board
DDPC	Department for Donor and Partner Coordination
FBOs	Faith-Based Organizations
GIS	Geographic Information Systems
GISEDP	Garissa Integrated Socio-Economic Development Plan
GPEDC	Global Platform for Effective Development Co-operation (GPEDC)
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
KIPPRA	Kenya Institute of Public Policy Research and Analysis
KNBS	Kenya National Bureau of Statistics
MEAL	Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability, and Learning
NDMA	National Drought Management Authority
PREG	Partnership for Resilience and Economic Growth
UNRCO	United Nations Residence Coordinator

FOREWORD



Garissa County has long been a focal point for development cooperation, hosting a diverse range of actors including government agencies, international and local NGOs, bilateral and multilateral donors, civil society organizations, and private sector partners. These investments have contributed significantly to improvements in health, education, water and sanitation, livestock development, resilience building, and infrastructure expansion. Yet, the growing number of actors has also underscored the risks of fragmented interventions, duplication of efforts, and inefficient use of resources.

It is against this backdrop that the County Government of Garissa has developed the **Partnerships and Coordination Policy**. This policy is a pioneering initiative, one of the first of its kind in Kenya's arid and semi arid lands (ASALs) and only the third across the country. It seeks to provide a robust framework for harmonizing development cooperation, strengthening alignment with county priorities, and enhancing mutual accountability between development partners and the County Government of Garissa. By establishing clear principles, standards, and mechanisms, the policy ensures that all interventions are coherent, sustainable, and responsive to the needs of our communities.

The policy resonates with the aspirations of the **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)**, particularly **Goal 17 on partnerships**, and is anchored in Kenya's constitutional and legislative frameworks. It reflects our collective commitment to government led development, transparency, and mutual accountability. Most importantly, it provides a solid foundation for fostering meaningful partnerships that will continue to positively and sustainably impact the lives of Garissa County residents.

H.E. HON. NATHIF JAMA EGH
GOVERNOR
COUNTY GOVERNMENT OF GARISSA

PREFACE



The Partnerships and Coordination Policy for Garissa County represents a landmark step in strengthening development cooperation within our County. Garissa has long been a hub for diverse actors ranging from government agencies, international and local NGOs, bilateral and multilateral donors, civil society organizations, and the private sector—whose contributions have significantly advanced health, education, water and sanitation, livestock development, resilience building, and infrastructure.

Yet, the increasing number of actors has also highlighted the risks of fragmented interventions, duplication of efforts, and inefficient use of resources. This policy responds to those challenges by providing a coherent framework that harmonizes development cooperation, aligns external support with county priorities, and enhances mutual accountability between partners and the County Government.

Anchored in Kenya’s constitutional and legislative frameworks, and resonating with the aspirations of the Sustainable Development Goals—particularly Goal 17 on partnerships—this policy affirms our collective commitment to government-led development, transparency, and inclusivity. It establishes clear principles, standards, and mechanisms to ensure that interventions are coherent, sustainable, and responsive to the needs of our communities.

I call upon all stakeholders—development partners, civil society, community representatives, and the private sector—to embrace this policy as a shared platform for collaboration. Together, we can build resilient systems, reduce duplication, and ensure that every investment contributes meaningfully to the long-term prosperity of Garissa County.

Hon. Zahra Musa

County Executive Committee Member (CECM)

Department of County Affairs Public Service & Intergovernmental Relations

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT



The development of this policy was made possible through an inclusive and participatory process that brought together a wide range of stakeholders. We recognize the invaluable contributions of county departments, development partners, civil society organizations, consultants, and community representatives, whose insights and recommendations shaped the direction and content of this policy.

We wish to acknowledge the leadership of the **County Secretary, Hon. Mohamud Mursal**, whose oversight ensured alignment with Garissa County's governance priorities. We extend our gratitude to the **County Executive Committee Member, Hon. Zahra Musa**, for her strategic leadership and unwavering support, and to the Chief Officer, Jamal Mohamed Ali, for providing the technical vision necessary to guide this process. Special recognition is accorded to the **Director of Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partner Coordination, Mohamed Dubow Aden**, for coordinating the drafting process and facilitating stakeholder engagement.

We also appreciate the active participation of development partners, civil society organizations, and community representatives, whose perspectives enriched the policy and strengthened its legitimacy. Their engagement ensures that this framework is not only technically sound but also grounded in local realities and responsive to the needs of our people. Special thanks to UNICEF, UNRCO, RCK, Islamic Relief, INKOMOKO and VNG for providing support.

This policy is more than a document—it is a collective commitment to structured coordination, joint planning, information sharing, monitoring and evaluation, and resource mobilization. We call upon all stakeholders to uphold its principles and work collaboratively to ensure that development support in Garissa County remains coherent, impactful, and sustainable.



Jamal Mohamed Ali

Chief Officer

Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partner Coordination

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DEFINITION OF TERMS

Area-Based Approach (ABA): A coordination mechanism that organizes interventions geographically e.g. Dadaab refugee operation sites, ensuring that multiple actors working in the same area sequence, layer, and integrate their programmes for maximum impact.

Accountability: The obligation of partners to assume responsibility for their actions, ensuring clear delineation of roles, commitments, and mechanisms for oversight and delivery of agreed-upon objectives.

Annual Development Plan (ADP): A statutory plan prepared by the County Government each year, detailing short-term priorities, projects, and resource allocations for the upcoming financial year. The ADP operationalizes the CIDP by translating medium-term strategies into annual targets, budgets, and measurable outputs, and serves as the foundation for the County Program-Based Budget (PBB).

County Aid Information System (CAIS): A digital platform for recording, tracking, and reporting donor and partner commitments, disbursements, and activities at county and ward level. It enhances transparency and reduces duplication.

County Sectoral Plan: A medium-term plan prepared by a county department outlining sector priorities, strategies, and programmes over a ten-year period. It is aligned to the CIDP and provides the basis for annual work plans, budgets, and performance monitoring within the sector.

Compliance: Adherence to relevant legal frameworks, regulations, and ethical standards governing partnership development and execution, ensuring conformity with established norms.

Development Cooperation: An approach that formally establishes a relationship between two or more parties engaged with each other to pursue development-oriented mutual interests.

Development Partners: Stakeholders who are engaged with each other in mutually beneficial development activities and without whom the intended activity objectives cannot be achieved.

Division of Labour Framework: A sector-level tool that defines the comparative advantage of each partner, clarifies roles, and reduces duplication by assigning responsibilities based on expertise and resources.

Integrity: Upholding ethical principles, moral standards, and honest practices within partnerships, emphasizing reliability, trustworthiness, and adherence to established norms.

Joint Program: A set of activities contained in a joint work plan and related common budgetary framework, involving two or more organizations and (sub-) national governmental partners, intended to achieve results aligned with national priorities as reflected in UNDAF/One Programme or an equivalent programming instrument or development framework. The work plan and budgetary framework form part of a Joint Programme Document, which details roles and responsibilities of partners in coordinating and managing the joint activities.

Joint Work Planning: A structured process to co-plan, co-implement, co-monitor, and co-review multi-stakeholder activities aligned to County priorities.

Memorandum of Understanding (MoU): A formal agreement between the County Government and a development partner outlining roles, responsibilities, financial commitments, and reporting obligations.

Mutual Accountability: The principle that both the County Government and development partners are jointly responsible for honoring commitments, reporting on progress, and being answerable to each other and to citizens for the use of resources and achievement of agreed results. It emphasizes reciprocal oversight, shared performance reviews, and transparent reporting mechanisms.

Partnership: A formal collaborative engagement between the County Government of Garissa and external entities, established on mutual benefit, shared objectives, and reciprocal value creation.

Program-Based Budget (PBB): A budgeting approach that links resources to specific programmes and measurable outputs, ensuring accountability for results rather than just inputs.

Resource Mobilization: The process of gathering, managing, and optimizing external resources, including funds, grants, and contributions, to support County initiatives and developmental projects.

Stakeholder Engagement: Inclusivity and active involvement of all relevant parties, including County departments, partner organizations, and community representatives, in decision-making processes and collaborative endeavors.

Sector: A thematic area of public service delivery or development programming (e.g., health, education, agriculture, water, environment) organized under a lead County department. Sectors provide the framework for planning, budgeting, and coordinating interventions aligned to the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP).

Sector Working Group (SWG): A multi-stakeholder coordination platform co-chaired by the relevant County department and lead development partner(s). SWGs bring together government, partners, civil society, and technical experts to jointly plan, monitor, and evaluate sectoral interventions. They serve as the operational mechanism for harmonization, division of labour, and accountability at the sector level.

Sequencing, Layering, Integration (SLI): methods to order, stack, and integrate interventions to maximize collective impact.

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background Information

Garissa County, located in Kenya's arid and semi-arid lands (ASALs), has historically been a major recipient of humanitarian and development assistance due to chronic challenges such as poverty, food insecurity, drought, conflict, and refugee-hosting pressures (especially from Dadaab refugee camps). As a result, numerous donors, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), community-based organizations (CBOs) and development partners work in Garissa County with the average number of years these organizations have been active in Garissa County being 14 years with some having been active for up to 33 years, indicating a significant long-term presence and sustained commitment to development in the County.

The County Government of Garissa continues to recognize the need and potential for effective development cooperation between partners and the County Government, as well as among partners themselves. Taking cognizance that effective development plans recognize the complementary roles of donors and partners (development partners) in achieving mutually held humanitarian and development assistance objectives, the second Garissa County Integrated Development Plan 2023-2027 (CIDP) identified the need for effective coordination of donors and partners' activities in the County as a key strategic priority and outlined a series of steps that would be crucial to achieving this over the medium-term.

Firstly, the CIDP declares the County Government's commitments to lead the development of a policy framework as one of the key strategies it will implement to enhance donor coordination and partnerships within the County.

Secondly, to understand the core areas of focus for development partners and to design appropriate coordination mechanisms the County Government of Garissa, in collaboration with Garissa University and with support from the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) undertook a Donor Mapping and Financial Analysis Study in 2024. This study revealed that in the financial year 2023/2024 alone, development partners spent more than Kshs 2.7 billion on various programs within the County with more than Ksh 1.5 billion of this spending directed towards livelihood programmes.

However, despite these high aid inflows, results have often been fragmented due to poor coordination mechanisms among development partners themselves, between development partners and the County Government of Garissa and between different departments within the County Government. Many development challenges such as poverty, illiteracy, unemployment, gender violence, and conflict still persist demonstrating the need to enhance transparency and accountability among development actors through the development of a donor coordination and partnership policy framework.

Finally, the CIDP underscores the need to enhance donor coordination and partnerships through the establishment of formal coordination mechanisms for all development partners and NGOs operating in the county. This is envisaged through a raft of measures including the mapping of development partners and the development of a register for development partners, the establishment of a mechanism for joint planning quarterly meetings to be held with all development partners, and the establishment of the Garissa County Coordination Committee, which once formed, is expected to enhance the coordination of donors and partners by eliminating the duplication of development

projects and wastage of resources, ensuring equitable distribution of donor funded projects across the county, while providing an opportunity for collaboration in the inception, design, planning, budgeting, resource mobilization, implementation, as well as the monitoring, evaluation and reporting of humanitarian and development assistance activities in the County.

1.2 Policy Issue(s) Identification

In spite of the laudable efforts made through existing coordination platforms, key challenges such as **fragmentation**, **off-budget opacity**, and **irregular coordination** limit the effectiveness and sustainability of development cooperation within Garissa County. The **County Steering Group (CSG)**—the long-standing forum for multi-agency coordination within the county—lacks legal anchoring, predictable resourcing, standardized data, and enforceable reporting rules and terms of reference (TOR). Despite the CSGs’ intended design (monthly meetings, multi-stakeholder membership, secretariat support), in practice, it is convened irregularly, with uneven data submissions, weak secretariat capacity and limited follow-through on decisions. Further, the County lacks a consolidated donor register and aid ledger and defined entry/exit procedures for development partners working within Garissa County. This misalignment weakens the efficiency and effectiveness of external resource utilization within the County and erodes transparency and mutual accountability between development partners and the County Government of Garissa and among development partners themselves.

1.3 Rationale

Despite high levels of external assistance, Garissa County lacks a consistent, institutionalized coordination system that ensures alignment of external resources with county priorities, reliable forecasting, asset sustainability, and accountability. This leads to multiple critical consequences including the **unpredictability of funding flows** undermining planning and budgeting, **duplication or gaps in services** due to fragmented coordination and geographic inequity in the distribution of development partners’ projects and activities, **hidden cost liabilities** particularly around operations and maintenance (O&M) of donated assets, weakening of the County’s internal capacity due to the **limited use of county public finance management (PFM) and procurement systems** and the **reduced sustainability of initiatives** when partners exit or shift their priorities. This policy seeks to provide guidelines for the effective coordination of development partners working in the County. Addressing these challenges through the development of a standalone policy for donor coordination and partnerships is necessary due to the following factors:

- i) **Undefined entry and exit procedures** – entry and exit processes for development partners seeking to work within Garissa still remain undefined. This has resulted in some development actors operating within the County without registering their presence and synergizing their efforts with the Department responsible for resource mobilization, donor Coordination and partnerships. This Policy will define a Partner Entry Process that will guide development actors seeking to work in the County.
- ii) **Institutional weaknesses in existing coordination structures** – at present, coordination between partners and the County Government, and occasionally among partners themselves is ad hoc and mainly undertaken through the CSG. However, the CSG lacks statutory/legal mandate, has a limited secretariat, and relies largely on goodwill and individual institutional leadership. This policy aims to establish a coordination forum anchored in a legal instrument to provide clarity on the mandate, terms of reference (TORs), and roles and responsibilities of various stakeholders in the County’s development cooperation efforts.
- iii) **Limited information sharing** – the absence of real-time data systems, harmonized digital aid platforms, and coordinated reporting protocols continues to obscure the true scope and effectiveness of external resource flows into Garissa County.

- iv) **Stakeholder dynamics** – development partners within Garissa County have tended to work in isolation, with little or no incentives for systematic joint planning, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation and reporting;
- v) **Geographic inequity, duplication and wastage of resources** – databases of development partners and their work within the County are scanty inhibiting proper planning, layering, sequencing and targeting of programs by the County Government and development partners. This has led to an overconcentration of partners in certain geographic areas resulting in some wards receiving many projects while others are neglected leading to wastage of resources.
- vi) **Lack of alignment of incentive structures:** development partners working in the County often lack tangible coordination incentives. Incentive structures are rarely set up to support coordination among development partners.

1.4 Policy Goal

This policy aims to institutionalize a legally-anchored, well-resourced, inclusive, and data-driven donor coordination and partnerships system in Garissa County that aligns all external assistance with articulated county development priorities, optimizes use of county systems, increases predictability and transparency of external flows, and strengthens sustainability of outcomes.

1.5 Policy Objectives

The main objective of this policy is to provide a direction on effective coordination of donors and partners operating in the Garissa County. The specific objectives of this policy are:

- i. To enhance a greater sharing of objectives and clearer expectations between donors, development partners and the County Government of Garissa for more predictable and transparent aid flows.
- ii. Institutionalize coordination structures with clear mandates, ToRs, annual calendars, a county budget line, and biannual reviews synchronized to CFSP/ADP milestones.
- iii. To align the County Coordination System with existing or parallel coordination mechanisms, including the CSG, and UNHCR and DRS-led platforms in Dadaab, in order to ensure coherence, reduce duplication, and enable joint planning and reporting under a unified county-led framework.
- iv. Adopt standardized MoUs and joint work planning templates for all partners.
- v. Operationalise a County Aid Information System (CAIS) with quarterly ledgers, ward maps, and dashboards with GPEDC-aligned indicators.
- vi. Align donor and partner portfolios to the CIDP/ADP/MTEF with on-budget visibility and O&M planning.
- vii. Improve predictability & mutual accountability between the County Government and development partners and amongst development partners themselves using GPEDC-aligned reporting and an Annual Joint Review.
- viii. Broaden inclusion & localization, guaranteeing CSO/private sector participation in donor coordination structures.
- ix. To ensure effective coordination of sourcing and management of external resources.
- x. To align external resources with the County's development priorities.
- xi. Strengthen mutual accountability frameworks between the County Government and development partners and amongst development partners themselves.

1.6 Guiding principles

The policy is anchored in internationally recognised aid effectiveness principles: **ownership**, requiring the county to set and drive its own development strategies; **alignment**, requiring donors and partners to align their assistance with the county's priorities, policies and systems; **inclusive partnerships**, promoting broad and meaningful participation of government, development partners, civil society, private sector and affected communities; **transparency and mutual accountability**, ensuring open information, clear performance expectations and reciprocal oversight; and **harmonization**, calling on donors and partners to coordinate actions, simplify procedures and share information to minimise duplication and transaction costs.

1.7 Structure of the Policy

This Policy has Five Chapters and Annexes. Chapter One provides the introduction, background information and context of development cooperation in Garissa County. Chapter Two presents the situation analysis with regard to development cooperation globally, nationally and locally. Chapter Three presents the key policy statements and action areas. Chapter Four presents the implementation and coordination framework for this policy, while chapters five and six provide mechanisms for monitoring, evaluation and review of this Policy.

CHAPTER 2

SITUATION ANALYSIS

This Chapter presents a situational analysis of donor coordination and partnerships in Garissa County, offering insights into the current legal and policy frameworks governing development cooperation at the County, National, and International level. It delves into an in-depth review of these frameworks and identifies the key strengths of and challenges to development cooperation within Garissa County revealing gaps between the current state of donor coordination relative to the desired state as modelled in the legal and policy frameworks referenced below. It highlights the gaps in policy and practice and critical focus areas requiring attention to enhance the effectiveness of development cooperation in Garissa County.

2.1 Global Context

Official development assistance fell for the first time in five years, according to preliminary 2024 data released on 16 April by the intergovernmental Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, or OECD. Members of the OECD's Development Assistance Committee (DAC) – mainly donor countries from the Global North – gave \$212.1 billion (approximately Kshs. 27.560 trillion) in development assistance, including some \$24.2 billion in humanitarian aid. This was a 7.1% drop in development assistance from 2023, and a 9.6% drop in humanitarian aid. The United States, which provides nearly 30% of all aid globally, has closed down its main aid agency USAID and suspended majority of its aid. Similar cuts have been witnessed in the United Kingdom signaling a future of declining aid budgets. Another important shift is the placing of more emphasis on humanitarian aid over development cooperation (longer-term development assistance). While hope remains that they will be a resurgence of aid funding, it is clear that the size and focus of aid funding will be radically different. This will create a shift in the way development assistance programs are funded and organized and a wholly changed aid ecosystem where greater transparency and coordination will be required in order for different funders and aid recipients to play their roles efficiently.

2.1.1 The Sustainable Development Goals

Goal 17 of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), 'Partnership for the Goals', emphasizes the importance of partnerships at all levels – global, regional, national, and local – with a focus on strengthening the implementation of partnerships for collaboration and coordination across different sectors and stakeholders to ensure different actors work together effectively towards common goals.

SDG Target 17.15 requires providers of development cooperation (development partners) to “respect each country's policy space and leadership to establish and implement policies for sustainable development.” To monitor Target 17.15, **SDG Indicator 17.15.1 seeks to measure the extent of use of country-owned results frameworks and planning tools by providers of development cooperation.** Under the leadership of the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and the Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD), through the Global Partnership for Effective Development Co-operation (GPEDC), countries are expected to collect and analyse data on the effectiveness of development cooperation by conducting a biennial Partnership Monitoring Exercise (Global Partnership Monitoring Exercise).

The Global Partnership Monitoring Exercise aims to track the implementation of Effective Development Co-operation commitments, aimed at implementing the four development effectiveness principles – country ownership, a focus on development results, inclusive partnerships, and enhancing transparency and mutual accountability. This data provides an evidence base for SDG 17 and SDG 5 and helps countries assess how effectively all actors work together to support national development priorities and development results. Garissa County will participate in GPEDC monitoring by aligning partner reporting to country-owned results frameworks (SDG 17.15), using County-level indicators and templates.

2.1.2 Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Provisions on Development Cooperation

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Development Assistance Committee (DAC) set up a special task force to look at how aid can be delivered more effectively through the simplification and harmonisation of donor procedures. Following extensive discussion with multilateral organizations and partner countries, the DAC Task Force on Donor Practices outlined the elements of a good institutional framework for aid co-ordination as follows:

- i. Consensus between government and development partners on objectives and strategy – (development of a common agenda);
- ii. Agreement on the forums, rules and timetables to manage public private dialogue between development partners and government;
- iii. Arrangements between different development partners to enhance co-ordination and to simplify procedures where it is not possible to use partner government systems; and
- iv. The development of internal rules and culture that encourage development partner staff to behave collaboratively and flexibly in order to form effective partnerships with partner governments and other development partners.

The DAC Task Force on Donor Practices also recognized the legitimate interests of partner governments in autonomy of action, and in the transparency and predictability of aid flows. Further, it outlined good practices for creating effective donor-partner government relationships which broadly include:

- i. **Sharing information:** requirements on donors to set out the objectives, and indicative operations (programmes, projects, activities etc.) that they plan to support in an explicit, open, country programme that draws on common analysis and takes into account the need for alignment of these operations with the partner government's articulated development objectives and priorities;
- ii. **Multi-year programming of aid:** the combination of longer term and more predictable finance through multi-year funding commitments (subject to performance) enables partner governments to plan their medium term macroeconomic and fiscal projections and have more trust in the reliability of donor finance which is needed to plan increases in service delivery capacity;
- iii. **Use of joint monitoring and evaluation frameworks and common performance indicators:** donors and partner governments should agree on a common framework, developed through a consultative process, for the monitoring and evaluation of external assistance interventions;
- iv. **Transparency:** donors should aim to provide information on aid flows in a regular and timely manner to enhance mutual accountability and allow for the publication of details of aid received;

- v. partner government leadership in aid co-ordination: in order to link aid to development planning and budgeting processes, partner governments should lead the overall consultative institutions, including organising and chairing coordination forums and public-private dialogue meetings, working groups and similar arrangements, and providing the secretariat.

2.2 National Context

2.2.1 Kenya's External Resources Policy (KERP)

The Kenya External Resources Policy (KERP) which was adopted in December 2014 provides the country's policy blueprint for engaging and managing external resources at both the national and county level. It lays down Kenya's principles for the sourcing and management of Official Development Assistance (ODA) towards achieving Kenya's long-term national development goals as per Kenya Vision 2030. KERP principles are firmly anchored on the Monterrey Consensus on Financing for Development (2002), the Rome (2003) and Paris (2005) Declarations on Aid Effectiveness, the Accra Agenda for Action (2008), the Busan Partnership for Effective development (2011) and the Global Partnership First High-Level Meeting in Mexico (2014). KERP reaffirms the leadership role of the Government in managing external resource flows, and defines clearly how ODA should be sourced and managed at both levels of government and by Non-State Actors bearing in mind the need to achieve high development impact while reducing the transaction costs involved. The National Treasury is in the process of reviewing KERP and has developed a revised draft Kenya External Resources Policy 2025. The Policy's proposed Act and CAIS interoperability will align to the revised KERP 2025 and DES guidance for effective development cooperation.

2.2.2 Kenya Effective Development Co-operation Strategic Plan (2018 – 2022)

Kenya is a signatory country to multiple development effectiveness agendas including the Monterrey Consensus on Financing for Development (2002), Paris Declaration on Aid Effectiveness, Accra Action Agenda (2008), the Busan Partnership for Effective Development Co-operation which was endorsed in 2011 by 161 countries and the Addis Ababa Action Agenda (2015). To support the Government of Kenya, Development Partners, and other stakeholders in meeting these commitments, the Aid Effectiveness Secretariat later renamed the Development Effectiveness Secretariat (DES) was constituted within the Resource Mobilization Department of the National Treasury.

Besides acting as the secretariat to the Development Effectiveness Group, DES' core mandate is to develop, update, and coordinate implementation of the DEG work program. It is also the custodian of the Kenya External Resources Policy (2014) with a responsibility to support National and County Governments, Development Partners, Non-State Actors and other stakeholders in implementing its policies, principles, and procedure to guarantee efficient and effective management and coordination of external resources in Kenya. Garissa County shall domesticate these principles by ensuring that all donor and partner engagements reflect these global standards and are coordinated through county-led systems aligned to the Kenya External Resources Policy and the Development Effectiveness Secretariat's guidance.

2.3 Garissa County Context

The average development partner has been active in Garissa County for an average period of fourteen (14) years indicating significant long-term presence and commitment. The range in years of operation spans from a minimum of 2 years to a maximum of 33 years, showcasing both newer entrants and well-established organizations. Studies by Garissa University and the Kenya Institute of Public Policy Research and Analysis (KIPPRA) both reveal spatial inequity in the geographic distribution and concentration of development partners and their projects and activities within Garissa County. Both studies consistently found that Dadaab and Garissa Township Wards consistently show a higher concentration of partners and projects compared to more remote, poorly connected, and insecurity-prone wards such as Liboi, Bura, and Hulugho. While the elevated presence in Dadaab is partly justified by the existence of refugee camps and the humanitarian infrastructure surrounding them, this pattern underscores the need for deliberate policy measures to ensure equitable distribution of development assistance across all wards, including those with limited connectivity and heightened vulnerability.

The nature (forms) of partnerships that have been established between the County Government and development partners can be categorized into four (4) forms:

- i. **Bilateral Partnerships:** where development partners work directly and exclusively with the County Government, focusing solely on activities and projects within Garissa County were found to be the dominant mode of partnership accounting for 45% of total collaborations.
- ii. **Multilateral Partnerships:** which bring together multiple stakeholders to pool resources and expertise, allowing for a broader, more collaborative approach to addressing the county's needs through joint initiatives accounted for 29% of partnerships. The outpacing of multilateral partnerships by bilateral partnerships demonstrates the need for broader coordination and cooperation between development actors in the County.
- iii. **Non-Governmental Partnerships:** which were characterized as partnerships usually driven by NGOs working in collaboration with the county government, focusing on areas such as community development, education, healthcare, and humanitarian aid.
- iv. **Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs):** which make up a small fraction, with just 3% of the partnerships. PPPs typically involve collaboration between the government and private sector entities, focusing on long-term projects such as infrastructure development, though their prevalence is currently limited.

Development partners working in Garissa County are actively engaged in a variety of focus areas and sectors though the education sector is the most popular sector of focus for development partners with ongoing initiatives in the County with 59% of the development partners surveyed listing the education sector as an area of focus for their past and ongoing interventions. The Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) sector is another major area of focus for development partners, with 55% of those surveyed involved in projects aimed at improving water access and sanitation facilities. Other notable focus areas for development partners include; Health (38%), Climate Change and Environmental Sustainability (38%), Social Protection (31%), Gender and Protection (24%), Nutrition (21%) Governance and Policy Development (21%), Livestock Production (17%), County Infrastructure (7%), and Crop Production (3%).

In addition to the sectors previously outlined, development partners in Garissa County are involved in several other critical areas that address diverse and often crosscutting needs. These focus areas include child protection, emergency response, and economic empowerment, among other vital interventions. Past development initiatives undertaken in Garissa County have focused on several key sectors, each addressing the unique challenges faced by county residents.

2.3.1 Table 1: Thematic areas emerging from the past initiatives undertaken by development partners in Garissa County

Sector	Frequency
Health and Nutrition	19%
Education	19%
Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH)	14%
Child Protection	12%
Livelihood and Economic Empowerment	12%
Disaster Response and Resilience	9%
Gender-Based Violence (GBV) and Protection	7%
Community Engagement and Capacity Building	9%

2.4 Key Strengths of Existing Donor Coordination and Partnership Mechanisms

2.4.1 Institutional Capacity of Existing Donor Coordination Structures

Donor coordination and partnerships are boosted by the existence of coordination structures such as the County Steering Group (CSG) – a coordination platform for all development partners in the County – the County Engagement Forum (CEF) – a platform where the DDPC engages with donors and partners, and Partnership for Resilience and Economic Growth (PREG) – a coordination facility for USAID-funded projects. Existing coordination platforms bring important value. Here are some of their strengths and notable achievements:

2.4.1 Proven Multi-Agency Convening Power

The County Steering Group (CSG) remains a key coordination platform. It brings together county government, national agencies (e.g., NDMA), development partners, NGOs, and other stakeholders. For example, in Garissa County, recent CSG sessions have successfully convened national, county, and partner actors around drought preparedness, mitigation, and response, early warning, and contingency planning. Such multi-agency meetings help align actors around shared disaster response priorities such as the provision of food and non-food aid, cash transfers, water, sanitation, and hygiene services, emergency shelter and flood rescue and response and increase coherence and alignment in planning and resource mobilization for emergency response.

2.4.2 Flexibility & Responsiveness

Because the CSG is not rigidly bound by legislation, it can sometimes convene more rapidly in response to crises. In Garissa County, for instance, the CSG has quickly been activated to address escalating drought and flood crises, with a technical committee established to coordinate response and monitoring. This agility is valuable in fragile, shock-prone contexts, where timely coordination is critical.

2.4.3 Community Involvement & Ownership

Existing coordination mechanisms have also included active community-level participation and involvement in helping to build ownership for projects especially at the sub-county level where for example Sub-County Steering Groups (S-CSGs) have been formed. Such inclusion enhances legitimacy, ensures that interventions are grounded in local realities, and can support sustained impact.

This approach has been reinforced by partnership models such as PREG, which emphasizes joint planning and sequencing of interventions with community structures to strengthen resilience outcomes. PREG's layered programming has enabled communities to co design livelihood and resilience projects, thereby embedding ownership and accountability at the grassroots level.

Similarly, the UNHCR led Area Based Coordination (ABC) mechanism in Dadaab has institutionalized community representation by engaging refugee led organizations (RLOs) and host community groups in thematic working groups. This ensures that both refugee and host populations participate in decision making, project prioritization, and monitoring, thereby enhancing legitimacy and sustainability of interventions in refugee hosting areas.

2.4.4 Donor-Donor Coordination Mechanisms

Donor-Donor Coordination Mechanisms provide transparent platforms that help development partners exchange information and develop a common perspective. Within Garissa County, many such mechanisms exist.

2.4.4.1 The Partnership for Resilience and Economic Growth (PREG)

PREG via USAID, provides a platform to align development and humanitarian partners implementing USAID grants around long-term resilience in arid and semi-arid land (ASAL) counties. Through PREG, counties like Garissa have benefited from joint planning, co-financing, and multi-sector coordination approaches which have helped to bridge the development-humanitarian divide. Donor-Donor Coordination Mechanisms such as PREG have provided a platform for USAID implementing partners and the County Government of Garissa to share information and understanding, agree on a common agenda for action, agree on solutions and jointly develop a detailed shared action plan. Each USAID implementing partner can then undertake the specific set of activities at which it excels in a way that supports and is coordinated with the actions of others.

2.4.4.2 UNHCR-Led Area-Based Coordination (ABC) Forums

In Garissa County — particularly the sub-counties of Dadaab and Fafi, which host large refugee populations in the Dadaab complex — UNHCR leads area-based coordination (ABC) mechanisms which are coordination platforms involving UN agencies, NGOs, refugee-led organizations, and host-government actors. These mechanisms feed into the broader Garissa Integrated Socio-Economic Development Plan (GISED), a multi-stakeholder area-based development strategy co-led by UNHCR and Garissa County Government. Within GISED, coordination is structured via a Steering Committee, thematic working groups, and a Secretariat. The ABC mechanism brings together a wide range of actors, enables joint analysis of challenges, joint planning, and collective decision-making through for example, data-sharing and joint assessments that help define real needs across services in different sectors. Because GISED is explicitly designed as a development-oriented plan, ABC coordination is not limited to short-term humanitarian response but is anchored in long-term service delivery and development goals aligned with Garissa county's CIDP.

2.4.5 Sector Working Groups

Sector Working Groups (SWGs) remain the primary mechanism for coordinating development partner activities within Garissa County across thematic areas such as Health, Water Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH), Agriculture, Livelihood Development, Education, Urban Planning and Infrastructure, Environment and Climate Change, and Social Protection. They provide structured platforms for dialogue, planning, and technical exchange between County departments, development partners, civil society, and community-based organizations. SWGs have enabled

alignment of partner interventions with County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP) priorities and Annual Development Plans (ADPs), ensuring that external resources contribute to sectoral objectives. They facilitate regular technical exchange, joint assessments, and harmonized standards, particularly in Health, WASH, and Nutrition, where coordinated outreach has improved service delivery. SWGs provide visibility of partner activities through mapping exercises, reducing duplication and highlighting gaps in service delivery. Thematic technical working groups in the fields of Nutrition and Social Protection have proven effective in mobilizing rapid responses and resources during droughts and floods.

2.4.6 Contribution to Disaster Response and Resilience Planning

In Garissa County, the CSG has played an instrumental role in developing contingency plans informed by early warnings for droughts and floods, leveraging meteorological forecasts and multi-stakeholder input. These plans improve preparedness, help mobilize resources early, and coordinate disaster response across sectors and humanitarian actors, showcasing the value of the CSG when effectively convened.

2.5 Key Challenges to Effective Donor Coordination and Partnerships

2.5.1 Weak Institutional Capacity of Existing Donor Coordination Mechanisms

Despite the existence of multiple donor coordination mechanisms, their effectiveness is hampered by various challenges as described below.

2.5.1.1 Sector Working Groups (SWGs)

SWGs often operate without legal anchoring, relying on administrative arrangements that are vulnerable to leadership changes and political turnover. Participation is inconsistent, with fluctuating attendance and weak follow-through on agreed action points. Reporting and data integration remain limited, with SWG outputs not systematically captured in a County Aid Information System (CAIS) or linked to sector performance dashboards. Fragmentation persists, as parallel platforms such as the County Steering Group (CSG), Area-Based Coordination (ABC) in Dadaab, and World Bank project coordinators operate outside unified county-led structures, creating duplication and siloed operations.

2.5.1.2 The County Steering Group (CSG)

The County Steering Group (CSG), originally established under the National Drought Management Authority's (NDMA) Drought Coordination Framework, functions as a largely administrative arrangement without legal anchoring in county legislation. This means that the forum is not anchored in county legislation and lacks a formalized terms of reference (TOR) making it vulnerable to deprioritization and disruption during political transitions — including changes in Governors, County Commissioners, or Chief Officers. These leadership shifts often erode institutional memory and weaken continuity.

The absence of statutory grounding also creates risks of role duplication and mandate confusion with other coordination structures which operate parallel to the CSG framework and the Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC) such as Sector Working Groups (SWGs), and the Area-Based Coordination (ABC) mechanism in Dadaab led by UNHCR and involving over 40 international and national non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and refugee-led organizations (RLOs) further fragmenting coordination efforts and limiting county oversight of development assistance.

Unreliable operational budgets for the CSG have resulted in irregular meeting schedules, weak secretariat capacity, and insufficient resources for real-time data collection, GIS mapping, or modern information management systems. Secretariat functions such as convening and data-management are often done by NDMA or sector officers within county departments, in addition to official responsibilities often with limited resources and less sharply defined deadlines reducing follow-up and analytical capacity. Further, despite monthly mandates, the CSG is often convened majorly during crisis or when funding is available.

Stakeholder dynamics have also led to gaps in the participation and membership of the CSG. Network type mechanisms such as the CSG rely on informal relationships, voluntary participation, and the goodwill of individual actors rather than enforceable mandates, statutory authority, or institutionalized reporting obligations and are suited for horizontal coordination where the actors do not have authority over each other. Effective coordination forums, on the other hand, rely on involvement of the right actors and cooperation between actors whose relationships are governed by interdependencies, trust and the responsibilities of each actor. However, the dominance of a few actors, low private sector participation, and variable NGO engagement have reduced the forum's inclusivity.

2.5.2 Fragmented Joint Programming Processes

The humanitarian, development, and peace nexus (HDP) is a complex programming area involving a wide breadth and number of stakeholders from multiple fields and sectors, each with distinct objectives, priorities, and resources. Despite this diversity and complexity, the activities of development partners acting within the nexus are often mutually-reinforcing and aimed at achieving collectively agreed upon development objectives and priorities. This presents an opportunity for the sequencing, layering, and integration of interventions by multiple development partners.

Sequencing involves the design of appropriate interventions in a timely and logical sequence in order to make complementary contributions to the overall impact of the program. Layering involves intensified and coordinated strategic planning to ensure efficient value addition between interventions implemented by different development partners based on the overall design of the programs. Finally, Integration involves multiple development partners working across many sectors and scales to achieve a shared vision and objective.

Strengthening joint programming processes is one of the key recommendations put forward by development partners to improve coordination between development partners and the County Government as well as among development partners themselves. In the context of Garissa County, 45% of partnerships established between the County Government and development partners are bilateral in nature – involving just the County Government and one other development partner – as opposed to multilateral partnerships – which involve multiple stakeholders who pool resources and expertise, allowing for broader, more collaborative approaches to addressing the County's development challenges through joint initiatives which account for only 29% of the partnerships established.

Donor-Donor Coordination Mechanisms such as PREG have demonstrated the value of joint programming approaches such as co-creation and joint work planning in supporting the joint design, planning, implementation, learning, and reporting of PREG activities. This collective approach has ensured that resources are utilized efficiently, with minimal wastage and duplication of efforts while ensuring that interventions are responsive to community needs and articulated county development priorities.

However, once established, resources are often required to maintain standalone Donor-Donor Coordination Mechanisms. The availability of reliable funding was identified as one of the main factors for the success of joint programming partnerships such as PREG. Sustainability can be an issue in cases where operational budgets for coordination structures are heavily reliant on donor funding which often wanes as project funding ends. Donors often delegate coordination to grantees, and fail to allocate sufficient resources for such tasks unintentionally limiting coordination among grantees and impeding efforts to sequence, layer, and integrate activities and interventions and leverage opportunities to joint programming.

Existing joint programming processes within the County are characterized by limited involvement of County Government Departments and staff in the design of development partner projects and activities; weak mutual accountability frameworks, limited oversight of partners, as well as non-alignment of development partner programming to the priorities articulated in the County's development plans. These weaknesses in joint programming manifest through outcomes such as:

- a) The duplication of projects and activities;
- b) Targeting of the same beneficiaries;
- c) Gaps in services due to poor sequencing, layering and integration of interventions;
- d) Geographic inequity in the distribution of projects and activities financed by external assistance in the County;
- e) Hidden cost liabilities particularly around the operations and maintenance (O&M) of donated assets;
- f) Limited use by development partners of county public finance management (PFM) and procurement systems;
- g) Irregular convening of coordination structures due to unreliable operational budgets;
- h) Reduced sustainability of initiatives when partners exit or shift their priorities;
- i) The lack of a consolidated development partner register and aid ledger; and
- j) The inefficient use of external assistance resources.

Further, when asked about the challenges they have faced during the implementation of interventions in Garissa County, 17% of development partners surveyed cited coordination between themselves and the County Government as a key challenge they have encountered during implementation of projects in the County. Finally, challenges such as cultural barriers (17%) and community resistance or rejection (24%) reflect a disconnect between project goals and community needs and demonstrate the need for greater community participation and engagement during project design.

Despite these challenges, joint programming efforts within the County are bolstered by the timely preparation of County development planning and budgeting documents which include the CIDP, Annual Development Plans (ADPs), the County Fiscal Strategy Paper (CFSP), the County Budget Review and Outlook Papers (CBROP), alongside County Sectoral Plans (CSP). These frameworks developed through inclusive public private dialogues provide a solid foundation on which development partners can base their programming in order to increase ownership and align their projects and activities with the needs and priorities articulated in County's development frameworks.

2.5.3 Unpredictable Funding Flows

Breakdown of Garissa County's Financial Year 2024/2025 Resource Envelope

Conditional allocations from development partners – donor-funded projects channeled through county systems – play a significant role in Garissa County's resource envelope. **In the Financial Year 2024/2025, for example, Kshs. 1,006,519,423 was received as conditional grants from development partners.** This was equivalent to approximately 10.13% of the total resource envelope that financial year.

DDPC obtains reasonable budgetary allocations from the County Government budget to undertake its mandate, which includes the coordination of donors and partners. In addition, the Department has a valuable chance to: channel its needs into the planning and budgeting process, and leverage on the existence of financial management systems and controls within the County Government to build donor confidence. The participatory planning and budgeting process is essential for improving allocations for coordination activities, enhancement of stakeholder engagement and alignment of objectives, while promoting transparency and accountability. However, funding for coordination structures remains inadequate leading to the irregular convening of coordination forums, unreliable operational budgets, weak secretariat capacity due to the lack of finances to establish a dedicated secretariat, delayed and stalled implementation. Delayed disbursements from the exchequer also affect the implementation of projects and activities delaying the release of county counterpart financing.

2.5.4 Monitoring and evaluation/Information Sharing

The Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships has inadequate mechanisms to oversight, monitor and evaluate projects implemented by development actors in the County. M&E operations are undermined by the lack of a common framework, developed through a consultative process, with common performance indicators and appropriate tools to track project performance and facilitate data sharing between development partners and the County Government for the monitoring and evaluation of external assistance interventions. M&E efforts are also frustrated by the lack of clear pathways for sharing data, non-existence of data sharing frameworks, unwillingness of some partners to share data, internal partner policies that restrict the sharing of data externally and limited knowledge on the importance of data sharing. This limits the Department's access to information on donor and partner activities in various sectors and hampers accountability and transparency.

Further, the effectiveness of the M&E function in relation to donor and partner coordination is threatened by development partners' diverse and uncoordinated M&E systems, bureaucratic bottlenecks, limited involvement of line departments in co-designing programs and projects spearheaded by development partners, lack of proper structures to monitor partner activities and budget constraints. This frequently results in the duplication of projects and activities and inequitable unbalanced development across the County.

These challenges could be addressed by developing a comprehensive M&E framework with common performance indicators and clear paths for information sharing within Government structures at various levels, and between the Government and development agencies. County statistical abstracts provide important information on partner activities, which DDPC can use to update the County Aid Information System. The availability of partners willing to support staff user capacity building on various software platforms for tracking donor and partner activities in the County (aid information systems), particularly to improve the County Government's understanding of project outcomes and to enable the assessment of funding needs leading to more strategic donor engagements.

2.6 Policy, Legal and Institutional Frameworks

2.6.1 *The Constitution of Kenya 2010*

The Constitution recognizes two levels of government; the national and the county level with prescribed functions. Chapter Eleven on devolved government, mandates cooperation and coordination between national and county governments by way of exchanging information, coordinating policies and administration, and enhancing capacity. The two levels of government are also required to cooperate in performing functions and exercising powers.

2.6.2 *The County Governments Act, 2012*

This Act accords county governments the power to enter partnerships with both private and public organizations. Section 6 (3) of the Act allows a county government to enter such partnerships “for any work, service or function for which it is responsible within its area of jurisdiction” outlining principles under Section 102 for planning and development facilitation that are crucial for effective resource mobilization towards sustainable development at the county level.

2.6.3 *The Inter-Governmental Relations Act, 2012*

This Act outlines several key facilitation mechanisms crucial for effective resource mobilization towards sustainable development at the county level. These mechanisms include fostering collaboration and coordination between national and county governments, establishing clear frameworks for resource sharing and information exchange, and providing platforms for capacity building. The Act also provides a forum for coordination of government policies, legislation, and functions.

2.6.4 *County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP) 2023 - 2027*

This policy has also been aligned with the current County Integrated Development Plan. The CIDP reiterates that County Government of Garissa shall, pursuant to the Fourth Schedule and Articles 185(2), 186(1), and 187(2) of the Constitution, be responsible for— (a) harmonization of services rendered in the county; (b) coordination of development activities in the county; (c) coordination of intergovernmental functions; and

2.6.5 *Garissa Integrated Socio-Economic Development Plan (GISED P)*

GISED P is a multi-year comprehensive multi-sectoral and multistakeholder initiative with an initial phase covering 2023-2027 and a follow-up phase from 2028-2032, in alignment with the CIDP Phases III and IV, respectively. It aims to transform the traditional refugee response model from humanitarian aid to development-focused outcomes in alignment with the Global Compact on Refugees (2018). GISED P has a robust partnership and coordination framework whose aim is to strengthen strategic and operational collaboration through the combination and leveraging of complementary resources in a strategic and transparent manner between the private sector, development partners, UN agencies under the One UN initiative, and the County Government of Garissa.

To achieve this, it proposes the development of detailed and streamlined sectoral and thematic work plans under each thematic working group co-chaired by the County Government of Garissa and UNHCR together with partners. Recognizing that a number of functions under GISED P are devolved, the County Government of Garissa is expected to co-lead various coordination structures through the Governor, County Executive Committee Members (CECMs), and sub-county officials. The GISED P Steering Committee will coordinate with national level UN coordination bodies and the Office of the UN Resident Coordinator (UNRCO) to ensure each UN agency’s full participation both at the county and national level in planning, joint programming (including inclusion of refugees in

the core joint program areas), resource mobilisation, joint advocacy, and monitoring and evaluation. Private sector actors will be represented in the various GISED P coordination structures through their associations and platforms. The coordination structure involves the full participation of both implementing and operational partners, particularly at the relevant thematic and technical working groups, operational at county and sub-county levels. Representation of NGO Partners is to be ensured in all relevant coordination structures. The coordination of activities will include joint assessments, program design, implementation, and monitoring and evaluation of interventions as well as joint advocacy and resource mobilisation.

2.6.6 *Shirika Plan*

The Shirika Plan is a multi-year, locally anchored, multi-stakeholder initiative designed to strengthen the resilience and self-reliance of refugee-hosting communities in Garissa County, with a particular focus on inclusive economic development, social cohesion, and institutional capacity-building. Its initial implementation phase spans 2024–2028, with a follow-up phase envisioned for 2029–2033, aligned with CIDP Phase III and IV and complementary to the GISED P framework. The Shirika Plan is grounded in the principles of the Comprehensive Refugee Response Framework (CRRF) and the Kalobeyei Integrated Socio-Economic Development Programme (KISED P), and seeks to localize these approaches within Garissa’s governance and planning systems.

The Shirika Plan promotes a transition from fragmented humanitarian programming to integrated, county-led development planning, with a strong emphasis on joint work planning, area-based coordination, and the use of county public financial management (PFM) systems. It establishes a layered coordination architecture that includes ward-level planning teams, sub-county coordination forums, and a County-Level Steering Committee co-chaired by the County Government of Garissa and UNHCR, with active participation from development partners, refugee-led organizations (RLOs), civil society, and private sector actors.

To operationalize its objectives, the Shirika Plan mandates the development of sectoral and thematic work plans under designated working groups, each co-led by County departments and relevant partners. These work plans are expected to be fully integrated into the County’s Annual Development Plan (ADP) and Program-Based Budget (PBB), with clear indicators, cost-sharing arrangements, and monitoring frameworks. The County Government of Garissa, through the Governor, County Executive Committee Members (CECMs), and technical departments, will co-lead implementation and ensure alignment with county priorities and legal mandates.

The Shirika Plan Steering Committee will interface with national coordination platforms, including the Development Effectiveness Secretariat (DES) and the Office of the UN Resident Coordinator (UNRCO), to ensure strategic coherence, resource mobilization, and policy alignment. It also emphasizes the role of refugee-led organizations and community-based structures in planning, implementation, and accountability processes. Coordination activities under the Shirika Plan include joint assessments, co-design of interventions, harmonized implementation schedules, shared monitoring and evaluation, and joint advocacy for sustained financing and policy support.

CHAPTER 3

POLICY STATEMENTS

This chapter sets out the County Government's policy statements and commitments to address the challenges identified in the situation analysis. For each policy statement, the chapter identifies gaps/weaknesses and offers policy interventions to address them to enhance donor coordination, partnerships, and resource mobilization.

3.1 Strengthened Coordination Structures

3.1.1 Policy Issues

Weak coordination mechanisms have resulted in inconsistent sector engagement, unstructured donor collaboration, poor flow of information, duplication of activities, lack of transparency and accountability, wastage of resources, and limited ownership and alignment of development partners' programmes and projects collectively constraining the coherence and impact of these initiatives. Strategic planning and evaluation remain underutilized, with limited use of evidence to inform project selection or review effectiveness. These institutional gaps hinder the realization of development results and obscure accountability.

3.1.2 Policy statement

The County Government commits to strengthening coordination mechanisms across all levels and sectors. This includes clarifying roles, deepening engagement across county institutions, reinforcing stakeholder collaboration, and leveraging technical capacity to enhance the effectiveness and coherence of development partners programmes and projects

3.1.3 Policy Direction: To ensure effective coordination mechanisms, the County will:

- i. Designate the Department responsible for Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partnership Coordination as the formal entry point for all development partners and focal point for all coordination structures.
- ii. Establish a legally anchored County Coordination Committee (CCC) and Secretariat with a ring-fenced budget line.
- iii. Develop a formalized government-led process for aid co-ordination and dialogue at the sector level.
- iv. Constitute and strengthen the effectiveness of Sector Working Groups (SWGs) and other joint dialogue mechanisms to institutionalize structured and inclusive engagement with development partners through legally anchored mandates, formalized Terms of Reference (TORs), and requirements for systematic reporting into the County Aid Information System (CAIS), joint annual work planning, annual and mid-term mutual accountability reviews, and coordinated monitoring and evaluation frameworks.
- v. Establish an annual calendar and clear timelines for coordination meetings of Sector Working Groups and other joint dialogue mechanisms and synchronize SWG calendars to PFM checkpoints: ADP (Sept 1), CBROP/CFSP (Oct–Feb), PBB (Apr 30), Appropriation (Jun 30).
- vi. Develop terms of reference (ToRs) for Sector Working Groups and other joint dialogue mechanisms in liaison with all stakeholders.

- vii. Ensure that all departments and development partners share timely reports and data with the Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partnership Coordination (which will host a GIS-enabled aid management information system).
- viii. Require JWP templates (plan, budget, M&E) for all partner engagements, signed by the County Secretary and partner leads.
- ix. Strengthen coordination structures to oversight and monitor programmes to ensure transparency and accountability.
- x. Adopt standard MoU/LOE with all partners and donors engaging with the County.
- xi. In collaboration with the National Government provide leadership in area-based coordination (Dadaab refugee operations).
- xii. Leverage external resources to support resource gaps in the CIDP.
- xiii. Coordinate programmes and projects under PPPs.

3.2 Monitoring and Evaluation

3.2.1 Policy Issues

The effectiveness of monitoring and evaluation (M&E) across all levels and sectors is hindered by the absence of a comprehensive M&E framework for development assistance, inadequate tools, unclear information-sharing pathways, limited involvement of line departments in program design, insufficient sector engagement for tracking partner activities, poor access to development partner's data, and persistent budget constraints which limit resources for M&E activities. These gaps result in fragmented reporting, duplication of efforts, poor accountability, and weak evidence-based decision-making.

3.2.2 Policy Statement

The County Government will implement a robust monitoring and evaluation framework to review the effectiveness of development partners' programmes and projects.

3.2.3 Policy Direction: To ensure a robust monitoring and evaluation framework, the County will:

- i. Establish integrated information-sharing pathways and digital platforms to enable real-time data exchange between the national government, county, government, humanitarian actors, and private sector and development partners.
- ii. Adopt a MEAL framework with common process, output, outcome, and impact indicators; run quarterly Pause-and-Reflect sessions and joint field visits and publish learning briefs.
- iii. Jointly establish relevant indicators and key performance indicators (KPIs) for projects and programmes funded by development partners.
- iv. Conduct regular joint monitoring and evaluation exercises in collaboration with development partners to assess the impact and efficiency of programmes and projects.
- v. Utilize M & E findings to inform future resource mobilization strategies and improve project design and implementation.
- vi. Facilitate bi-annual Sector Working Group monitoring and review meetings to review progress against targets set for each development partner across all sectors.
- vii. Integrate ward-level County Aid Information Management System (AIMS) dashboards for real-time tracking, mutual accountability and public transparency.
- viii. Where collective outcomes have been developed, follow the programme matrix's monitoring mechanism.
- ix. Ensure complementarity of interventions with development partners' result frameworks and the CIDP and other sectoral plans and strategies as appropriate.

3.3 Budgeting and Planning

3.3.1 Policy Issues

Funding shortfalls continue to undermine the effective implementation of action plans, resulting in delays, partial execution, and weakened coordination among donors and partners. These challenges are compounded by delayed exchequer disbursements, bureaucratic bottlenecks in the approval of donor-funded projects, and an overreliance on external financing. As a result, budget constraints remain a defining limitation within the Department of Donor and Partner Coordination, impeding its ability to deliver on coordination mandates, sustain joint planning processes, and ensure the long-term effectiveness of development assistance.

3.3.2 Policy Statement

The County Government shall enhance the impact and effectiveness of development assistance by strengthening coordination and coherence with development partners, leveraging their comparative advantages, and operationalizing the principles of development effectiveness—namely ownership, alignment, harmonization, inclusive partnerships, and mutual accountability. To reduce dependency on external financing and enhance sustainability, the County Government shall progressively mobilize domestic resources to co-finance development partner activities, particularly those aligned to priority sectors and vulnerable wards. This includes allocating matching funds in the County Program-Based Budget (PBB), leveraging conditional grants, and exploring pooled financing arrangements. Development partners shall be encouraged to structure their support in ways that complement county budget cycles, utilize county public financial management (PFM) systems where feasible, and promote long-term institutional capacity.

3.3.3 Policy Direction: To implement this Policy Statement, the County Government will:

- i. Define the potential roles of development partners in each sector in contributing to collective outcomes or jointly selected priorities where applicable through division of labour frameworks and area-based approaches (ABAs), with priorities and activities determined by the comparative advantage of the development partners involved.
- ii. Design collaborative, joint or joined-up or complementary programming that can be translated into measurable objectives.
- iii. Embed joint priorities and cost-shares in ADP, CFSP, and program-based budgets and publish County Government counterpart financing schedules and absorption rates in CAIS.
- iv. Establish partnerships across the humanitarian development spectrum based on stakeholder mapping to ensure complementary, sequenced and/or layered programming.
- v. Effectively involve development partners in county planning processes including the development of the CIDP, annual development plans (ADP), and sectoral plans.
- vi. Contribute to collective outcomes where applicable ensuring that collective outcome processes inform the development of the CIDP, ADP, and other sectoral plans and strategies.

3.4 Information Management

3.4.1 Policy Issues

Coordination is hampered by the poor flow of communication between partners and the County Government, as well as between government departments, and among partners themselves. This is due largely to the non-existence of data sharing frameworks, unwillingness of actors to share data, internal donor and partner policies that restrict sharing of data externally and limited knowledge on the importance of data sharing. In turn, this often leads to duplication of activities, hampers accountability and transparency and wastage of resources.

3.4.2 Policy Statement

The County Government will develop a data sharing protocol through a consultative process, detailing the responsibility of development partners to share information on programmes and projects in their domains

3.4.3 Policy Directions: To improve information management and enable data sharing, the County Government will:

- i. Approve a Data Sharing Protocol to aid quarterly submissions to CAIS and conduct data landscaping to determine what type of information and data are available to partners and identify areas of common interest.
- ii. Establish a comprehensive database of donor and partner-funded activities which will also include process, output, outcome, and financial data and provide information on the geographical distribution of existing interventions to minimize avoidable gaps and overlaps.
- iii. Request access and consult actors' databases and analyses, as appropriate.
- iv. Define clear paths for information sharing with development partners and stakeholders in, and outside the Government.
- v. Engage development partners identified through stakeholder mapping, as well as technical specialists, in data collection, design, compilation and analysis.

CHAPTER 4

FRAMEWORK FOR IMPLEMENTING THE DONOR COORDINATION AND PARTNERSHIP POLICY

Implementation is the process of executing policy by the Department's staff, in collaboration with stakeholders. This section focuses on specific structures, procedures and strategies that will be involved or deployed to coordinate or facilitate the policy's implementation. It covers the institutional framework, operational plan, financing, communication and review of the policy.

4.1 Coordination Framework and Administrative Mechanisms

Several stakeholders will play a critical role in the implementation of this Policy. Table 2 provides a list of roles and responsibilities for the various stakeholders who will facilitate the implementation of this Policy. Coordination of the activities undertaken by these stakeholders is the responsibility of the Department of Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC). The Policy also proposes the establishment of new structures namely the County Coordination Committee and the County Technical Forum to facilitate decision-making and collaboration with respect to matters concerning the coordination of donors and partners.

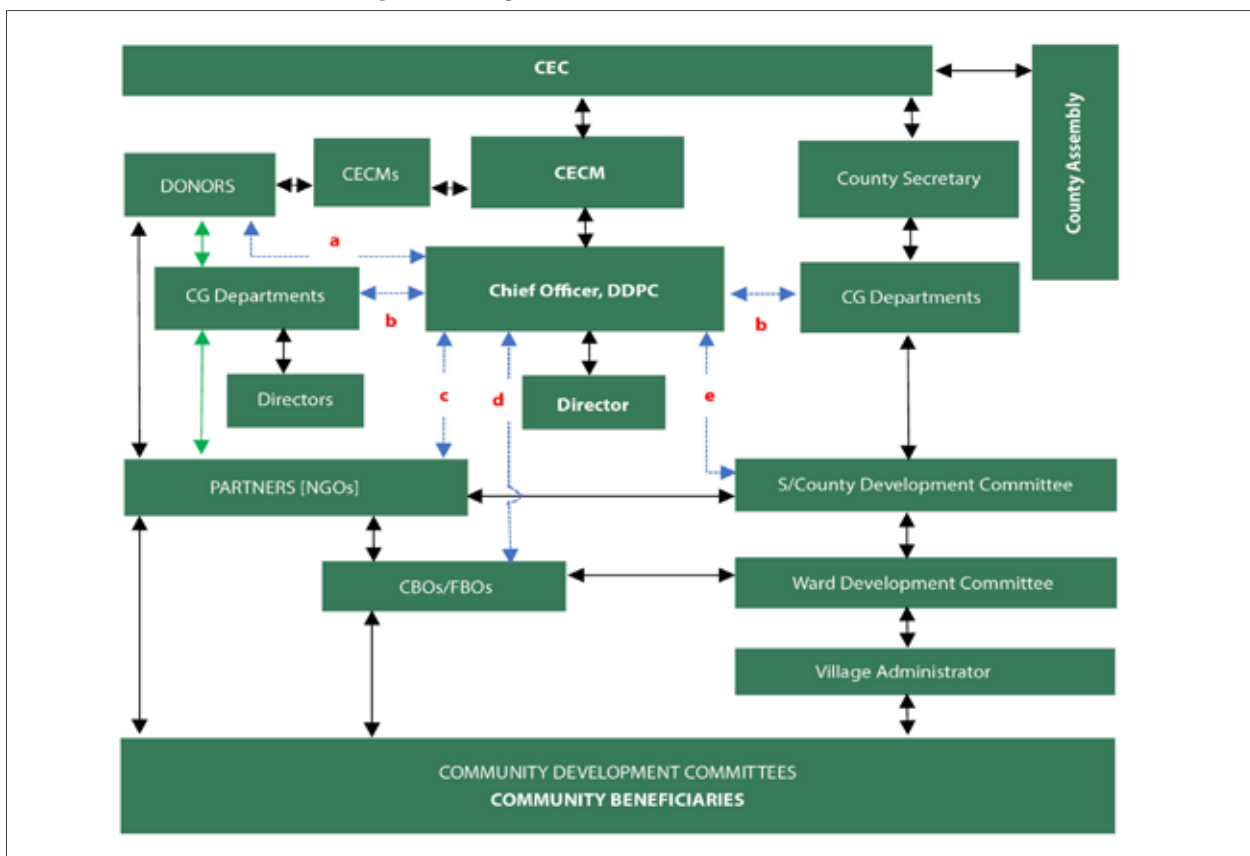
4.1.1 Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC)

The Department of Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC) shall be the custodian of this policy and will bear the mandate for its implementation. DDPC will implement the policy by streamlining coordination processes and coordinating humanitarian and developmental stakeholders in the County to avoid duplication, enhance collaboration, improve accountability and optimize impact.

The organogram in Figure 1 below shows the existing linkages between the DDPC and other development stakeholders in the County. The analysis revealed weak linkages between the Department and various stakeholders in terms of information sharing, reporting and feedback which inhibits coordination. Specifically, weak linkages exist between the Department and donors (a), other county departments (b), partners (c), CBOs/FBOs implementing development projects and the Sub-County Development Committee. In addition, several projects funded by multilateral institutions and operating across County departments e.g. Agriculture, Water, Urban Planning, Environment & Climate Change appoint project coordinators as prescribed in their project manuals. These project coordinators currently operate in parallel silos with limited integration into county coordination structures. This fragmentation undermines strategic alignment, creates duplication risks, and reduces the county's ability for joint work planning and information sharing.

Strengthening the cited weak linkages will be critical for improving donor and partner coordination by enabling the Department to access relevant information about development partners' activities in the County. This will be achieved by holding stakeholder consultative meetings and developing binding memorandums of understanding (MoUs) with development partners working in the County to ensure that all donors and partners interested in investing in the County, are referred to the DDPC for coordination with ongoing projects across the County. The information will be crucial for planning coordination activities, tracking project implementation and evaluating impact in the life and livelihoods of targeted communities. The green arrows show the links that should be weakened to improve coordination. This will make the Department the crucial point of entry into the County for donors and partners.

Figure 1: Linkages between the DDPC and Stakeholders



The Department will also leverage the presence of a wide breadth of diverse development partners in the County and the presence of the **UN Residence Coordinator (UNRCO)** in the County, to strengthen existing coordination structures through technical assistance and capacity development. The UNRCO is integrated in the Office of the County Secretary to enhance coordination.

4.1.2 Sector-Level Coordination via the Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor & Partner Coordination (DDPC)

Each county department in charge of a sector e.g., Health, Water, Agriculture, Education etc. shall take the lead in implementing this Policy at the sector level. Specifically, **each County Executive Committee Member (CECM) responsible for a sector will:**

- Constitute a Sector Working Group (SWG) which will be responsible for spearheading the process for the preparation of the County Sectoral Plan (CSP) for that sector which will serve as the sector development programme and include a sector expenditure framework (sector action plan properly costed and prioritised against a realistic estimate of government and external resources available in a sector).
- Issue a circular outlining the composition of the sector working group, its terms of reference (TOR) and timelines for accomplishment of milestones in the preparations of the CSP;
- Lead the development of the County Sectoral Plan for their sector in conjunction with the SWG;
- Develop and submit Joint Sector Work Plans and Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with development partners to the Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor & Partner Coordination (DDPC) for advisory review. The DDPC's review will focus on ensuring coherence with county-wide strategies, optimizing resource mobilization, and coordinating partnerships; and
- In preparing these joint sector work plans and MoUs, ensure SWGs articulate the sector strategic priorities, gaps, and proposed interventions, ensuring alignment with the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP) and Annual Development Plan (ADP).

4.1.2.1 Sector-Level Coordination Mechanisms

Section 109 of the County Governments Act obligates every County Department to develop a ten-year County Sectoral Plan (CSP) as component parts of the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP). The CSP should be:

- a) Programme-based;
- b) The basis for budgeting and performance management; and
- c) Reviewed every five years by the County Executive and approved by the County Assembly, but updated annually.

To operationalize sector-level coordination with development partners, sector heads and the DDPC will rely on existing coordination mechanisms and the tools provided in this Policy, including:

- i. Sector Working Groups: Regular meetings chaired by Chief Officers (or their designees) with the participation of partner representatives, technical staff, and DDPC, to plan, review, and coordinate partner activity in that sector.
- ii. Joint Implementation Committees (JICs): For large or multi-partner projects, the DDPC and sector departments will establish JICs to oversee project execution, harmonize partner contributions, monitor risk, and ensure accountability.
- iii. MoU Management and Review: MoUs entered into between development partners and county departments must be reviewed in a structured manner by DDPC, with feedback loops, renegotiation where necessary, and formal sign-off procedures.

4.1.2.2 Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability & Learning (MEAL)

The DDPC and sector departments will ensure active coordinated participation in project evaluation, capturing key lessons at close-out and integrating these into future project design. DDPC will facilitate joint learning events (workshops, peer reviews) to disseminate evaluation findings, best practices, and lessons across sectors and partners. Each sector is responsible for institutionalizing mechanisms within its domain that document successes, challenges, and lessons learned to inform future interventions. Specifically, the DDPC will liaise with the County Monitoring and Evaluation Committee (COMEC) to ensure the inclusion and participation of representatives of NGOs, and Civil Society Organizations in the County Citizen Participation Forum and Sector Monitoring & Evaluation Committees (SMEC) as proposed in the Garissa County Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Policy.

4.1.3 County Coordination Committee

The County Coordination Committee shall be the highest policy advisory body charged with overseeing the implementation of this Policy. The Committee will comprise of:

- a) The Governor;
- b) The County Commissioner or his designated representative;
- c) The County Executive Committee Member (CECM) responsible for Donor and Partnerships Coordination;
- d) The County Executive Committee Member (CECM) responsible for Finance and Economic Planning;
- e) The County Secretary;
- f) Chief Officer, responsible for Donor and Partnership Coordination who shall be the secretary to the Committee;

- g) Director responsible for Donor and Partnership Coordination;
- h) Representative from the UN Resident Coordinator's Office (UNRCO);
- i) Representative from the Dadaab Refugee Complex (UNHCR);
- j) Representative from the Private Sector;
- k) Representative of the Kenya Red Cross Society (KRCS);
- l) Representative from International Non-Governmental Organizations (INGOs); and
- m) Representative from Community-Based Organizations (CBOs)/Civil Society Organizations (CSOs).

The Committee will carry out the following functions:

- i. Provide strategic direction on policies and initiatives relating to the coordination of donors and partners;
- ii. Driving and fostering coordination of implementation of the policy strategies;
- iii. Supervise the operations and functions of the Technical Forum;
- iv. Approve budgets and workplans of the Technical Forum;
- v. Provide policy dialogue and direction for donor and partner activities; and
- vi. Strategic planning, conflict resolution, and resource mobilization.

4.1.4 County Technical Forum

This policy proposes the establishment of an inter-agency technical forum comprising of directors and focal point technical officers from line departments, development partners, civil society, refugee-led organizations (RLOs), the private sector, academia/universities, religious institutions and other relevant stakeholders. This forum will be chaired and convened by the Director of the Department responsible for Donor and Partner Coordination in the County. The composition of the County Technical Forum will consist of:

- a) Director of the Department responsible for Donor and Partner Coordination
- b) Director of the Department responsible for Finance and Economic Planning
- c) Director of the Department responsible for Water
- d) Director of the Department responsible for Education
- e) Director of the Department responsible for Health
- f) Director of the Department responsible for Intergovernmental Affairs
- g) Director of the Department responsible for Agriculture, and Livestock
- h) Director of the Department responsible for Climate Change
- i) Director of the Department responsible for Energy and Environment
- j) Director of the Department responsible for Gender and Social Services
- k) Director of the Department responsible for Peace and Cohesion
- l) Focal Point for Refugee Inclusion, GISEDEP/Shirika Plan
- m) Representative from Development Partners
- n) Representative from the Private Sector
- o) Representative from Civil Society Organizations/Refugee-led Organizations
- p) Representative from Academia/Universities; and
- q) Representative from Religious institutions.

The County Technical Forum will be accountable to the CCC and its functions will include:

- i. Lead co-creation workshops to compile sector Joint Work Plans (JWP) and submit consolidated JWP to CCC for approval using standardized templates;
- ii. Drawing operational workplans and budgets;
- iii. Information sharing;
- iv. Resource mobilization;
- v. Capacity building;
- vi. Monitoring and evaluation;
- vii. Drawing a calendar of operations;
- viii. Reporting and accountability.

4.1.5 Table 2: Coordination Roles and Responsibilities

Table 2 provides a list of roles and responsibilities for the various stakeholders, who will facilitate the implementation of this policy:

Stakeholder	Roles and responsibilities
County Steering Group (CSG)	- Coordination of national government projects in the County
Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination, Partnerships, and Resource Mobilization (DDPC)	- Be the first formal point of entry for every Development Partner and facilitate coordination between implementing Departments and development partners - Provide advisory support during partner's process of identifying and vetting CBOs/FBOs for downstream implementation. - Maintain a consolidated registry of local CBOs/FBOs and facilitate introductions and field verifications through standardized vetting checklists and capacity profiles; - Facilitate the process of MoU signing between development partners and the County Government as well as ensuring that the terms of MoUs are adhered to - Convene quarterly coordination meetings between development partners and implementing County Government Departments in accordance with the provisions of this Policy - Maintain a database of all development partners in the County and facilitate their entry and exit in accordance with the laid-down procedure described in this Policy document - Work closely with different county departments to identify projects that align with development priorities and are eligible for external funding - Develop comprehensive project proposals outlining objectives, budgets, and expected outcomes - Develop strategic plans for external resource mobilization aligned with the county's overall development goals and priorities through the identification of funding needs, potential donors, and strategic approaches to secure external support - Monitor the implementation of projects funded by external resources and provide regular updates to donors and partners. - Maintain close dialogue with multi-lateral institutions like the World Bank, IGAD, and FCDO, aligning their interventions with the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP). - Plan for Transition and Sustainability by negotiating exit strategies or co-financing models with multilateral partners early in project design, ensuring that interventions continue after donor support phases out. - Develop and submit comprehensive reports on the utilization of external funds, project progress, and outcomes. - Provide training and capacity-building initiatives for county staff involved in external resource mobilization ensuring that the county has a skilled workforce capable of effectively engaging with donors and managing donor-funded projects.

Stakeholder	Roles and responsibilities
Department of Finance and Economic Planning	- Lead the process of CIDP design and instruct County Government Departments to design Sectoral Plans aligned to the CIDP - Identify the funding gaps and specific project requirements that could be addressed through external resource mobilization. - Effective management of grants and loans by ensuring adherence to the terms and conditions of funding agreements, proper disbursement, and ensuring that funds are utilized for their intended purposes - Provide transparent, accurate and timely financial reports on the utilization of external resources to maintain trust with development partners and demonstrate the responsible use of funds - Assess and manage financial risks associated with external resource mobilization - Monitor and evaluate the impact of external resources on the achievement of the County's development goals - Publish absorption and counterpart financing performance
Other County Government Departments	- Take the lead in the implementation of this Policy at the Sector level and submit sector work plans and MoUs to DDPC for advisory review with respect to coordination, partnership and resource mobilization strategies - Coordinate all development partner engagements, donor meetings, and partnerled project planning, implementation, monitoring and closeout processes through the Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC). - Be responsible for ensuring that development partners understand strategic priorities of their respective sectors including gaps and key lessons learned from previous implementation - Encourage Partners to ensure that their Work Plans reflect the strategic priorities of the sector and projects are implemented in a way that contributes to the achievement of the objectives of the sector without compromising quality, efficiency, and sustainability - Coordinate Sector-specific activities of development partners using the coordination tools recommended in this Policy document - Play an active role during project evaluation and learn key lessons that will shape subsequent project design and implementation - Live up to their financial and other forms of commitments as expressed in signed MoUs with development partners - Ensure that partners' close out process is done in a way that will not leave avoidable gaps as a result of partners exit

Stakeholder	Roles and responsibilities
County Sector Working Groups	- Develop a comprehensive view of resource flows to the sector through the examination of sector expenditures, taking into account development partner expenditures that may be off-budget, and the contributions made by NGOs, RLOs, and the private sector - Review sector performance to determine the level of achievement, programme implementation, challenges and lessons learned - Work collaboratively with relevant departments to develop technically sound and comprehensive project proposals that meet the requirements of development partners. Provide expertise in designing projects with clear technical specifications - Participate in the identification of projects eligible for external funding, assessing their technical feasibility, and ensuring alignment with the county's strategic development goals - Collaborate with the Finance and Economic Planning Department to estimate the costs of projects accurately and provide input on resource requirements, including materials, equipment, and specialized personnel - Conduct needs assessments and technical analyses to identify the specific requirements and challenges associated with potential projects. Provide valuable input into the technical aspects of project planning - Ensure that projects adhere to established technical standards, codes, and regulations. Verify that proposed solutions and interventions meet industry's best practices and are following relevant technical guidelines - Establish monitoring mechanisms to oversee the technical aspects of project implementation. Regularly assess progress, technical quality, and compliance with project specifications - Provide training and capacity-building initiatives to project staff, ensuring that they possess the necessary technical skills and knowledge to implement projects effectively
Civil Society Organizations (CSOs)	- Ensure that development cooperation has a positive impact on communities by monitoring the implementation of this Policy and that feedback from communities is incorporated in the design and implementation of projects - Hold all stakeholders accountable for Value for Money (VfM) and responsiveness to the needs of the people
County Secretary	- Signs MOUs on behalf of the County Government - Resource mobilization - Co-signs the plan of operations with partners - Acts as linkage between the county government, partners and donors
County Commissioner	- Coordinates national government developmental projects - Head of the security at the county level - Co-chairs the county coordination forum with the county governor
County Assembly	- Reviews and approves policies, bills and regulations that facilitates coordination - Allocates budget resources to support coordination activities - Provides oversight to ensure accountability and transparency in coordination efforts. - Engages with stakeholders to understand community needs and ensure that they are reflected in the coordination activities - Approves county budgets and plans

Stakeholder	Roles and responsibilities
Donors, Partners and Multi-lateral Institutions	- Compliment the County Government development agenda through support to gaps in the CIDP and the ADP and the MTP. - Plan for Transition and Sustainability by negotiating exit strategies or co-financing models with multilateral partners early in project design, ensuring that interventions continue after donor support phases out. - Provide institutional capacity building support to the Department of Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC). - Support and facilitate the department of DDPC to effectively coordinate partners in the county. - Support the department of donor coordination in formulating bills and policies that support effective coordination. - Support the department in strengthening and enhancing coordination structures within the county to ensure effective coordination. - Liaise with the DDPC during the process of identifying and vetting CBOs/ FBOs for downstream implementation - Support the DDPC in mapping stakeholders operating in the County using the GIS technology. - Facilitate joint monitoring between the DDPC and partners to ensure effective monitoring of projects and programs. - Support the budget development process in coordination with the respective departments (CIDP, ADP). - Provide financial and logistical support to the directorate of donor and partnership. - Willingness to compromise or trade interests to facilitate collaboration with other organizations. - Willingness to share information about their projects.
County Coordination Committee	- Provide overall coordination of donors and partners, - Supervise the operations and functions of the Technical Forum, - Approve budgets and workplans of the Technical Forum, provide policy dialogue and direction for donor and partner activities, - Strategic planning, conflict resolution, and resource mobilization.
County Technical Forum	- Lead co-creation workshops to compile sector Joint Work Plans (JWP) and submit consolidated JWP to CCC for approval using standardized templates - Draw operational workplans and budgets - Information sharing - Resource mobilization - Capacity building - Monitoring and evaluation - Draw calendar of operations - Reporting and accountability

4.1.6 Partner Entry Process

All development partners seeking to operate within Garissa County shall formally engage through the Department of Donor and Partner Coordination (DDPC) as the designated entry point.

The entry process shall consist of the following steps:

1. **Expression of Interest:** Development Partners shall submit a formal letter of intent to the DDPC outlining proposed areas of engagement, target wards, and alignment with the County Integrated Development Plan (CIDP).
2. **Pre Entry Consultation:** DDPC shall convene a consultation meeting with the relevant County departments, Sub County representatives, and sector stakeholders to review the proposal against county priorities, existing interventions, and identified gaps.
3. **Due Diligence and Advisory Review:** DDPC conducts a capacity and compliance assessment of the partner, including review of governance structures, financial accountability systems, and track record. Advisory support will be provided to partners in selecting downstream implementing partners (NGOS/CBOs/FBOs), ensuring transparency and reducing risks of under performance.
4. **Memorandum of Understanding (MoU):** Upon successful review, the development partner shall sign an MoU with the County Government, stipulating roles, responsibilities, financial commitments, reporting obligations, and use of the County Aid Information System (CAIS).
5. **Integration into Coordination Structures:** Partners are formally inducted into the County Technical Forum, relevant Sector Working Groups (SWGs), and Joint Work Planning (JWP) processes.
6. **Continuous Reporting and Feedback:** Partners are required to submit quarterly activity briefs, financial updates, and evaluation reports to DDPC for consolidation and feedback.
7. **Exit and Close Out:** At the conclusion of engagement, partners must provide a close out report, including lessons learned, sustainability measures, and documentation, operation, and management of assets or handovers, to prevent gaps upon exit.

4.1.7 County Aid Information System

An information management system for development co-operation is an information and communication application that enables development partners to share data on development co-operation with the partner country government. They are generally owned and managed by governments and populated with information that development partners provide about their development co-operation with that country. Partner country governments can use this information for a range of purposes related to planning, budgeting and co-ordination. Governments can also make this information publicly available to be transparent about development co-operation received by the country. Aid information management systems (AIMS) are the most common type of these systems.

DDPC shall establish a County Aid Information Management System (CAIS) which shall be a single comprehensive system that centralizes and integrates all data generated from donor activities in the County including process, output, and outcome data. Once deployed CAIS will seek to: (a) track all donor-funded projects by sector, geography, and value. (b) standardize partner reporting templates (aligned with GPEDC indicators) and (c) support the production of real-time donor coordination data dashboards.

CAIS will also include data on the financial and other resources expended on development partner-supported projects in Garissa County and track the County-Government of Garissa's counterpart funding commitments and the proportion of committed funds released by the County Government for implementation. Quarterly dashboards and an annual Development Cooperation Report will be produced and published on the DDPC website.

Long-term, CAIS will be developed as a simple web dashboard with ward maps and key performance indicator (KPI) automations and should be designed for interoperability with other databases to reduce parallel reporting burdens. In the short-term however, a simple Excel Sheet schema of the minimum fields of data that partners will be required to submit quarterly is shown below:

Figure 2: Excel Sheet schema of the minimum fields of data that partners will be required to submit to CAIS

Project ID	Donor/ Partner Name	Sector	Sub-County	Ward	Project Title	Start Date	End Date	Budget (USD)	Budget (KES)	Funding Status	On-Plan (Y/N)	On-Budget (Y/N)	Pipeline Amount (USD)	Disbursement to Date (USD)	Asset Transfer Planned (Y/N)	O&M Plan (Y/N)	MOU Signed (Y/N)

4.1.8 Table 3: County Coordination Committee Meetings

The proposed County Coordination Committee will convene donor and partner coordination meetings. However, before the necessary legislative processes, the meetings will be convened by the Chief Officer, DDPC. The meetings will be held quarterly, and when need arises. The timing for quarterly coordination meetings, are as follows:

Quarter	Timing	Probable agenda	Quorum	Method
1	Last week of June – first week of July	- Review and Endorsement of Annual Joint Work Plan (JWP) - Alignment of JWP with Annual Development Plan (ADP) - Resource Mobilization Strategy for Coordination (cash, in-kind) - Institutionalization of Coordination Structures	Simple majority (50% + 1) of the membership	In person or virtual using Zoom or Microsoft Teams, whichever is preferred by 50% +1 of the membership.
2	Last week of September-first week of October	- Review of County Financial Strategic Plan (CFSP) priorities - Coordination of Multi-Sector Projects - Capacity Building Needs for Sector Teams		
3	Last week of January to first week of February	- Review of Program-Based Budget (PBB) Implementation - Status of Ongoing Partner Projects (progress, challenges) - County Annual Progress Report Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Update - Lessons Learned from Previous Year / Midterm Corrections - Planning for Next Year's JWP/ ADP Inputs		
4	Last week of March – First week of April	- Presentation of Year-End Development Cooperation Report by DDPC - Joint Review of Achievements, Challenges, and Emerging Lessons - Discussion on Closing/ Transition Plans for Projects - Exit/Handover Strategies for Partners - Validation of Lessons & Recommendations for Next Planning Cycle		

4.1.9 Communication Plan

Communication is essential for effective coordination of donors and partners. Communication plan is even more important for the implementation of the Policy intended to improve donor and partner coordination. The information to be communicated to stakeholders includes the County Government of Garissa's development agenda as articulated in the CIDP and ADP, changes in County development priorities, notices for coordination meetings, minutes of coordination meetings, security alerts, climate-related early warning alerts, newsletters as well as monitoring and evaluation reports, among others.

Coordination communications will target donors and partners, government departments at the county level, sub-county structures for coordinating donors and partners, ward-level structures for coordination, community-level structures working with implementation partners, and the national government administrative structure. The purpose of communication will be to promote meaningful partnership and enhance coordination to avoid duplication; uphold transparency and accountability, build and sustain donor and partner confidence, as well as enable stakeholders to come up with appropriate measures to address emerging issues in the coordination process. Feedback from stakeholders will be valuable for decision-making and for the sustainability of donor and partner coordination. Effectiveness of communication will be indicated by the timeliness of feedback and enhanced collaboration, and reduced grievances.

Communications to facilitate coordination of donors and partners will be done through convenient and cost-effective channels, including in group e-mails, WhatsApp group walls, quarterly roundtable forums, workshops, as well as through radio. Other channels will include the County Government Website, monthly bulletins by the DDPC, public barazas at the sub-county level, WhatsApp groups for SWGs, CAIS public dashboards, and feedback survey links. The choice of the channel to be used will be decided by the County Technical Forum, depending on the nature of the information to be communicated and the targeted recipients.

4.2 Legal and Regulatory Framework

In Garissa County, there is no currently no standalone Policy, Law or Regulation pertaining to donor coordination and partnerships. However, several policies, sectoral plans, Acts, Regulations and Guidelines provide support for effective donor coordination and partnerships.

This policy provides the basis for the establishment of an Institutional and legal framework for the management of development cooperation in the County. The legislative framework for resource mobilization, donor coordination and partnerships will be established through the Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships Act with provisions for:

- i. Establishment of the County Coordination Committee;
- ii. County Department responsible for the County Technical Forum (which shall be the Secretariat);
- iii. Other coordination structures at the lower units of County administration e.g. sector working groups, sub-county, ward, and village coordination committees;
- iv. Entry/exit procedures: Partner registration, due diligence, MoU standards, exit/asset handover with O&M plan
- v. Powers, functions and funding mechanisms for the County Coordination Committee;
- vi. Roles and responsibilities of development partners
- vii. Use of County systems: Preference for PFM and procurement systems where feasible;

- viii. Development of the County Aid Information System (CAIS);
- ix. Public transparency: Publication requirements for minutes, ledgers, dashboards, and annual reports; and
- x. Development and implementation of a strategic plan to guide resource mobilization, donor coordination, and partnership activities in the County.

The Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships Act will clearly outline institutional and legal arrangements to support all development cooperation activities and specify the roles and responsibilities for development partners, departments, and other stakeholders in resource mobilization, donor coordination, and partnerships.

To further aid implementation, the County Government of Garissa will also develop specific regulations and guidelines that will govern donor coordination, partnerships and resource mobilization activities within Garissa County. These regulations may include:

- i. Procedures for Partnership Engagement: Outlining criteria for selecting and engaging with partners aligned with the county's development agenda.
- ii. Resource Mobilization Guidelines: Defining processes for acquiring, managing, and allocating resources in compliance with legal requirements and best practices.
- iii. Monitoring and Reporting Mechanisms: Establishing frameworks for monitoring, compliance, and reporting on partnership activities and resource utilization.

4.3 Funding Arrangements

Implementation of the Policy will be financed by the County Government of Garissa, to a large extent, with the support of donors and partners. Indicative cost of implementation is estimated at KES 38 million, with major cost items being staff employment and training, strengthening data management and utilization, communication, coordination meetings, evaluation and review, as well as the legislative process in developing the Act.

The County Government has allocated KES 18 million for the Policy's implementation, which suggests a financing gap of KES 20 million. The Department has laid down various strategies to plug the financing gap, including: lobbying and advocating within the County Government for increment of the budget; mobilization of additional resources from donors and partners, through lobbying for voluntary funds and in-kind contributions by donors and partners.

The Department will adopt various strategies to mobilize supplementary funds, including: Mapping of partners with coordination budget allocations, developing concept notes for funding and co-financing, exploring opportunities for PPP aimed at enhancing coordination. Potential funding sources include: Embassies (Donors), Foundations, Partners (NGOs), Development Banks, Corporate entities. The Department will prioritize development of staff capacity to improve resource mobilization skills.

The Department takes cognizance of the various challenges, likely to constrain resource mobilization, including donor fatigue, diversion of funds during emergency situations, delayed accountability to donors and partners, as well as proliferation and fungibility. To cope with the anticipated challenges in resource mobilization, the Department will: focus on non-traditional donors, seek co-financing of donor and partner coordination activities, explore PPP opportunities to mobilize additional resources for coordination. It will also establish a pooled 'Coordination Fund' for joint reviews, CAIS operations, and SWG convenings from eligible sources including donors, foundations, private sector CSR, and PPPs and publish fund statements quarterly.

4.4 Revision of the Policy

The policy will be operational for a period of five years from the date of its adoption. The policy will be subjected to a mid-term review after 2 ½ years of implementation to address issues arising and to evaluate progress in the achievement of its objectives. The policy will be subjected to final evaluation at the end of 5 years of implementation. Thus, the policy will be a living document. The DDPC shall steward revisions and lead the development of the proposed Act/Regulations as needed.

CHAPTER 5

MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The workshop will develop the monitoring and evaluation plan for the policy's implementation.

Objective	Action	Output	Indicator	Timeframe	Indicative Cost (Kshs.)	Data Source	Data tool	Frequency of data source	Reporting	Dissemination	Responsibility
Designate DDPC as entry point	Issue a circular on DDPC mandate to all county departments and partners	DDPC legally recognized as single entry point	Circular issued; % of partners registered via DDPC Development Partner Registry	Dec 2026	1M	DDPC Development Partner Registry	CAIS, GIS registry	Quarterly	DDPC reports	Existing co-ordination structures DDPC website	DDPC, County Secretary
Establish the County Coordination Committee and the County Technical Forum	Draft TORs; allocate dedicated budget line;	CCC operational with Secretariat	CCC meetings held; dedicated budget line established	Dec 2026	3M	County budget, CCC minutes, CTF Reports	CAIS. Budget	Annually		Existing co-ordination structures DDPC website	Governor, CECM Finance and Economic Planning, DDPC
Formalize development partner and county government coordination at the sector level	Constitute and Strengthen SWGs; Draft and validate SWG ToRs with stakeholders; Conduct joint sector annual reviews	Functional SWGs with ToRs	# of SWGs with ToRs; % reporting into CAIS	Dec 2026	5M	SWG minutes, CAIS Reports	CAIS dash-board	Quarterly	DDPC	Existing co-ordination structures DDPC website	CECMs and Chief Officers of County Departments, County Secretary
Establish annual SWG calendar	Synchronize SWG meetings to PFM cycle	Annual SWG calendar	Calendar published; % adherence	Yearly	1M	SWG schedules	Calendar tool	Annually	DDPC reports	DDPC website	Chief Officers of County Departments, County Secretary
Require Joint Work Planning (JWP) Tools and templates	Develop standardized JWP templates	Signed JWPs	# of JWPs signed	June 2026	1M	JWP documents	JWP template	Annual	DDPC reports	DDPC website	DDPC, County Secretary
Develop model Partner MoU and Expression of Interest (EOI) letters	Draft standard MoU/EOI; require adoption	Partnership MoUs signed	# of MoUs signed	Dec 2026	1M	MoU Register	MoU template	Annual	DDPC reports	DDPC website	DDPC, County Secretary

Objective	Action	Output	Indicator	Timeframe	Indicative Cost (Kshs.)	Data Source	Data tool	Frequency of data source	Reporting	Dissemination	Responsibility
Leverage external resources	Develop resource mobilization strategy	Resource mobilization strategy	% of resource gap covered	June 2026	5M	Resource mobilization reports	CAIS, Budget	Annual	Treasury reports	DDPC website	DDPC, Department of Economic Planning and Finance
Establish integrated information-sharing pathways	Develop the GIS-enabled County Aid Information System (CAIS) to link county, national, humanitarian, development partner, and private sector systems	Real-time data exchange platform	% of partners connected # of data exchanges per quarter	June 2027	10M	Partner reports, ICT logs	GIS-enabled CAIS, dashboards	Quarterly	DDPC, ICT reports	DDPC website, CAIS public portal	DDPC, ICT Dept, NatGov
Adopt a unified MEAL framework	Design common indicators; run quarterly Pause-and-Reflect sessions; publish learning briefs	County MEAL framework operational	# of sessions held # of joint learning briefs published	June 2026	5M	MEAL reports, joint field visit reports	MEAL templates, dashboards	Quarterly	MEAL reports	DDPC website, CAIS public portal	DDPC, SWGs
Facilitate bi-annual SWG reviews	Schedule SWG monitoring and evaluation meetings to track sector progress	Bi-annual SWG review reports	# of meetings held % of targets reviewed	March 2026	5M	SWG minutes, CAIS	SWG review templates	Bi-annually	SWG reports	DDPC website, CAIS public portal	DDPC, SWGs
Ensure complementarity with CIDP & partner frameworks	Align interventions with CIDP/sector plans	Harmonized results frameworks	% of projects aligned # of CIDP-linked indicators	June 2026	3M	CIDP, partnership frameworks, MoUs	Alignment matrix	Annually	State of Development Co-operation Report DDPC reports	DDPC website, CAIS public portal	DDPC, Finance and Economic Planning Dept
Define roles of development partners by sector	Develop division of labour frameworks and apply area-based approaches (ABAs)	Sectoral role matrices	# of frameworks developed % of partners mapped by comparative advantage	June 2027	1M	Partner mapping reports	Division of Labour matrix	Annually	DDPC reports, Donor-Donor Coordination Reports	DDPC website	DDPC, SWGs, Donor-Donor Coordination Platforms
Design collaborative joint programming	Convene joint co-design workshops	Joint programme documents	# of joint programmes designed	June 2026	5M	Workshop reports, programme docs	JWP templates	Annually	SWG reports	DDPC website	DDPC, SWGs, Development Partners

Objective	Action	Output	Indicator	Timeframe	Indicative Cost (Kshs.)	Data Source	Data tool	Frequency of data source	Reporting	Dissemination	Responsibility
Embed joint priorities & cost-shares in budgets	Integrate priorities into ADP, CFSP, PBB; publish financing schedules in CAIS	Published cost-share schedules	% of joint priorities embedded absorption rates published	Yearly	2M	ADP, CFSP, PBB, CAIS	Budget templates, CAIS dashboards	Annually	County Treasury Reports	DDPC website	DDPC, SWGs, Development Partners
Involve development partners in county planning	Include partners in CIDP, ADP, sectoral plan development processes	Partner inputs documented	# of partners engaged % of plans with partner inputs	Yearly	5M	CIDP, ADP, CSP drafts, meeting minutes, workshop reports	Planning templates	Annually	Finance and Economic Planning Dept reports	County Assembly website	DDPC, Finance and Economic Planning Dept
Approve Data Sharing Protocol	Draft and validate protocol; conduct data landscaping with development partners	Approved Data Sharing Protocol; data landscape report	Data sharing protocol gazetted # of partners submitting quarterly data	Dec 2026	5M	Partner submissions, DDPC records	CAIS, GIS registry	Quarterly	DDPC reports	DDPC website	DDPC, ICT Dept
Establish comprehensive donor database (CAIS)	Design and populate database with process, output, outcome, financial, and geographic data	County donor/partner database	Database operational; % of projects captured	June 2027	5M	Partner reports, CAIS	GIS-enabled CAIS dashboards	Quarterly	DDPC reports	DDPC website	DDPC, ICT Dept
To ensure that there is adequate staffing to meet operational demand	Conduct strategic recruitment and redeployment.	Staff recruited	No of staff recruitment, retention and redeployment done	Immediate	7M	Department audit CPSB, HR, CS.	HR manual	Annually	HR report and CPSB audit report	CG website Correspondence	Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships
To improve staff capacity in modern data management systems as well as skills in modern coordination and communication tools	Train staff on modern data management systems	Staff skills enhanced on IT	# of trainings conducted	By June 2026	0.3M	desk review	Engage Consultant	Bi-annually	Training reports	CG website Correspondence	Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships
	Train staff on modern coordination and communication tools	Staff skills enhanced	# of trainings conducted	By June 2026	0.2M	desk review	Engage Consultant Organize learning visit	Bi-annually	Training reports	CG website Correspondence	Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships
To improve fund absorption rate through process optimization to ensure efficient use of resource.	Sensitizes the county leadership and encourage the use of E-government tools and platforms	Leadership sensitized	# of sensitization meeting held.	By June 2025.	0.5M	Reports generated from the workshop	Desk review, KIs,	annually	Workshop reports	CG website	Department of Resource Mobilization, Donor Coordination and Partnerships



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